2548

Executive Order

The following Act of Congress, approved March 2nd, 1917, is published for the information of all concerned:

"An Act to provide a civil government for Porto Rico and for other purposes.

"Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled, That the provisions of this Act shall apply to the island of Porto Rico and to the adjacent islands belonging to the United States, and waters of those islands; and the name of Porto Rico as used in this Act shall be held to include not only the island of that name but all the adjacent islands as aforesaid.

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"Sec. 11. That all reports required by law to be made by the governor or heads of departments to any official of the United States shall hereafter be made to an executive department of the Government of the United States to be designated by the President, and the President is hereby authorized to place all matters pertaining to the government of Porto Rico in the jurisdiction of such department."

Under this provision hereafter all official reports which the Governor of Porto Rico or heads of departments of the Government of Porto Rico may be required to make of the transactions of that government will be made to the War Department, and all matters pertaining to the Government of Porto Rico, except as otherwise provided by law, are placed in the jurisdiction of that department.

The business of the War Department pertaining to civil government in Porto Rico is, pursuant to Section 87 of the Act of Congress approved July 1st, 1902, assigned to the Bureau of Insular Affairs.

WOODROW WILSON

THE WHITE HOUSE,
21 March, 1917.

[No. 2548.]